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The Afghanistan Cricket Board has announced a new franchise-based T20 competition, the Afghanistan Premier League, with a five-team inaugural season planned for October 2026 in the UAE. Afghanistan will continue to stage its domestic Shpageeza Cricket League, featuring five teams, in the July-August window each year.



3

New Zealand all-rounder Doug Bracewell has retired from all forms of cricket at the age of 35. He last represented New Zealand in a Test in 2023 and finished his international career with 28 Tests, 21 ODIs and 20 T20Is between 2011 and 2023. The defining moment of his career came early, when match figures of 9 for 60 in Hobart in December 2011 powered New Zealand to its first Test victory in Australia in 26 years.



4

Ayush Mhatre has been named India's captain for the 2026 Under-19 World Cup, with Vihaan Malhotra appointed vice-captain. Both will miss the South Africa tour due to wrist injuries and report to the BCCI Centre of Excellence, linking up with the squad for the World Cup, where India opens against the USA on January 15 in Bulawayo. In the absence of both the captain and vice-captain, India will be led by Vaibhav Suryavanshi in the three One-Dayers in South Africa.



5

Gede Priandana, Indonesia's 28-year-old right-arm quick bowler, has become the first to pick up five wickets in an over in an international T20I match, achieving the feat in the first T20I against Cambodia in Bali. He is the first man or woman to achieve the feat. While this is the first time a bowler has taken five in an over in an international game, there have been 14 instances of a bowler taking four in an over before.



6

The BCCI has significantly revised pay for women domestic cricketers, bringing their match fees close to parity with the men. Under the new structure, women players will earn Rs. 50,000 per day for domestic one-day and multi-day matches, with non-playing members receiving Rs. 25,000 per match. For T20s, the playing XI will be paid Rs. 25,000, while reserves will earn Rs. 12,500.



7

New Zealand all-rounder Suzie Bates will miss the home series against Zimbabwe in February-March 2026 after sustaining a quadriceps injury. The 38-year-old will also be sidelined for the rest of the domestic season with Otago and is expected to be out of action for around three months. Bates is hoping to return to action in the white-ball series against South Africa in March.